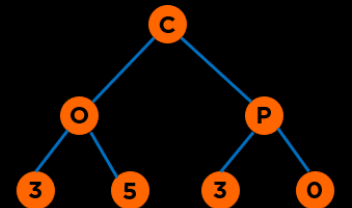


Data Structures & Algorithms

COP 3530 : Fall 2026



About Me: Amanpreet Kapoor

- Educator
- CS Education Researcher
- Mentor
- Software Engineer
- Lifelong Learner



kapooramanpreet@ufl.edu

Course Staff



Cole

(Head TA & Lead - Teaching)



Emma

(Lead - Communications)



Jackie

(Co-lead Infra)



Josh

(Co-lead Infra)



Adrian

(Lead Content)

Learners: Let's Get to Know You

Go To Menti.com

Code: 3655 6919

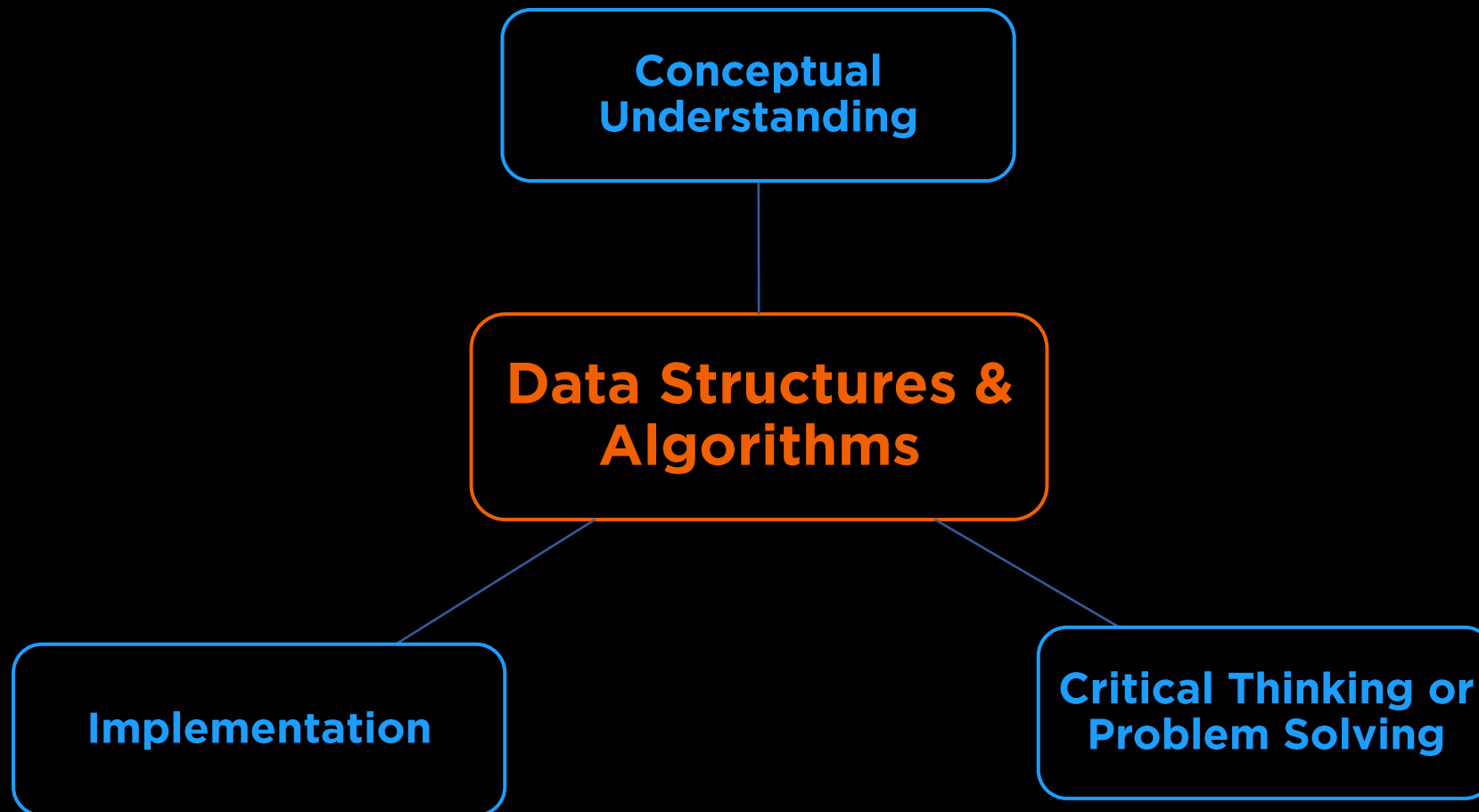
Course Objectives

What is this Course About?

This course covers algorithm development using

- **pseudo languages**
- **basic program structures**
- **program design techniques**
- **storage and manipulation of basic data structures**
- **3 Credit Hours**

What is this Course About?



Categories of Data Structures

Linear Ordered

Lists

Stacks

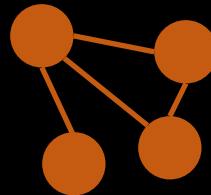
Queues



Non-linear Ordered

Trees

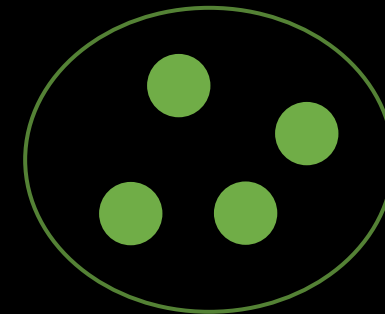
Graphs



Not Ordered

Sets

Tables/Maps



Categories of Algorithms

Brute Force

Selection Sort

Bubble Sort

Insertion Sort

NP Complete Problems

Divide & Conquer

Binary Search

Merge Sort

Quick Sort

Greedy

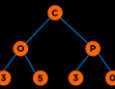
Minimum Spanning Tree

Shortest Paths

Dynamic Programming

Knapsack

Fibonacci

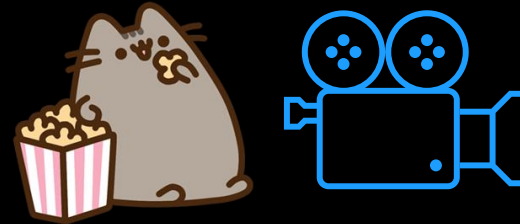


Logistics & Policies

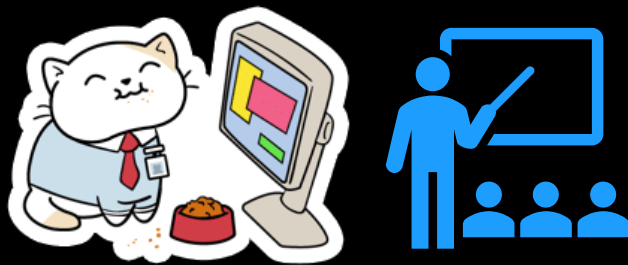
Format



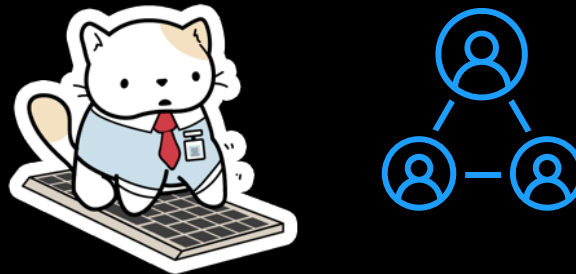
Action Items by Monday morning



Watch lectures synchronously on Tue and Thu in person or live via Zoom.



Attend discussions on Wed.



1. Conceptual Quiz due on Fri.
2. Programming Quiz due on Fri.

Communication

Slack



- Everything!
 - for all question related to the course
 - for communicating with peers
 - one-to-one communication with me
- Use Appropriate Tags
- Response in < 48 business hours

Office Hours



- Thursday, 4:05 – 6 pm
- By Appointment (24 hours in advance)

Communication



Email

Fine for

- Personal
- Accommodations
- Emergencies



Email

Not okay for

- Questions regarding logistics
- Questions on coding
- Fixing bugs

Communication


~~Canvas Messages~~


~~Phone Call~~



Debugging

- Students should visit the course staff during scheduled office hours for help and provide context for help.
- Debugging requests for projects/quiz questions must first go through the TAs or peer mentors. This is strongly encouraged given we have a large class and several of you might have similar questions.
- If your problem is not fixed, then start a conversation with both the Instructor and the TA/Peer mentor who you asked for help. Debugging requests to the Instructor as a Slack direct message or an email will be ignored if you do not follow the above protocol.

Grading

Modality	Assignment	% of Final Grade
Individual	Programming / HTG Quizzes (drop two lowest scores)	6%
	Conceptual quizzes (drop two lowest scores)	6%
	Exam 1	25%
	Exam 2	25%
	Project 1	12%
	Project 3	12%
	Class and discussion participation (drop four lowest scores)	4%
Collaborative	Project 2 (Individual or Group: 2a & 2b)	10%
Individual	Extra Credit Opportunities	Up to 2%
		Total: 102%

Total assessments: 26 excluding extra credit and class/discussion participation

Timeline

Week	Dates		Topic	Deadlines
1	20-Aug	23-Aug	Course Introduction/Algorithm Analysis	
2	24-Aug	30-Aug	Algorithm Analysis / List	Q ₁
3	31-Aug	6-Sep	Stacks, & Queues / Trees	Q ₂
4	7-Sep	13-Sep	Trees / Balanced Trees 1	Q ₃
5	14-Sep	20-Sep	Balanced Trees 2	Q ₄
6	21-Sep	27-Sep	Heaps & Priority Queues	P ₁
7	28-Sep	4-Oct	Sorting	Q ₅
8	5-Oct	11-Oct	Exam 1 (Oct 6 - 8:20 - 10:10 PM)	E ₁ , P _{2a}
9	12-Oct	18-Oct	Sets, Maps, & Hashing	Q ₆
10	19-Oct	25-Oct	Graphs 1	Q ₇
11	26-Oct	1-Nov	Graphs 2	Q ₈
12	2-Nov	8-Nov	Greedy Algorithms	P _{2b}
13	9-Nov	15-Nov	Dynamic Programming	Q ₉
14	16-Nov	22-Nov	Exam 2 (Nov 18 - 8:20 - 10:10 PM)	E ₂
15	23-Nov	29-Nov	Thanksgiving Break	
16	30-Nov	2-Dec	Complexity Theory	Q ₁₀ , P ₃
Legend: Q _N = Quiz N, P _N = Project N, E _N = Exam N				

Programming Language

Default (Project 1 & 3, Edugator, Quizzes):

C++14

Compilation command:

```
g++ -std=c++14 -Werror -Wuninitialized -o EXECUTABLE_NAME YOUR_FILE.cpp
```

Project 2:

Any Language

Tools

Compiler

- G++
- Edugator/Gradescope

IDE

- OnlineGDB
- Visual Studio Code
- Clion



Tools

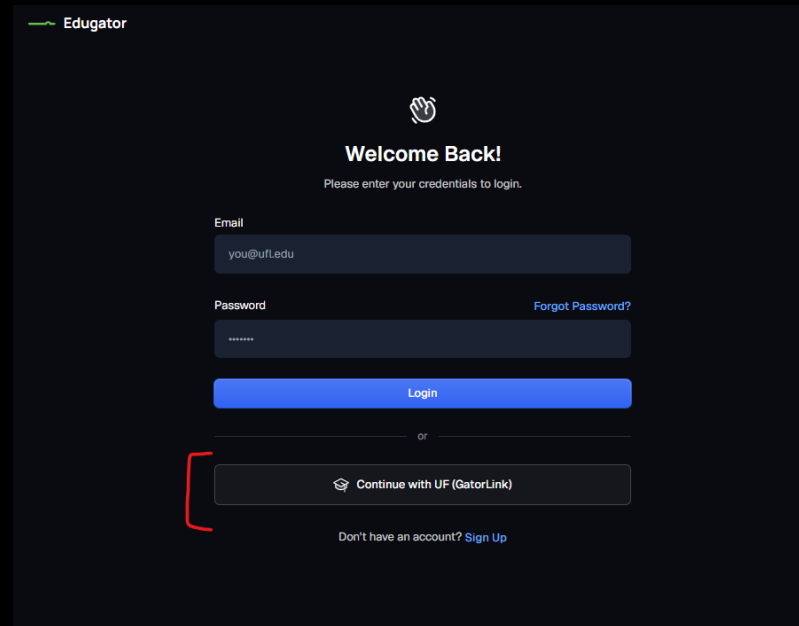
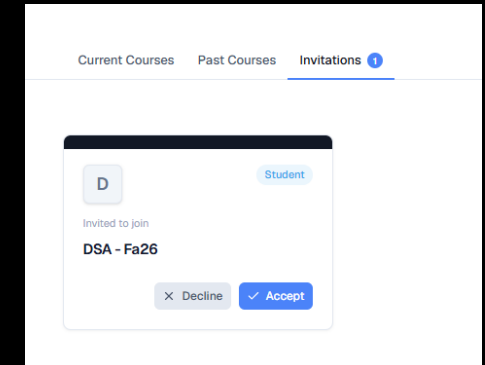
Edugator

We will be using **Edugator** (<https://edugator.app/>), a platform similar to technical interview and programming practice websites such as LeetCode. Edugator provides an organized environment where you can complete programming practice problems and keep track of your progress. You will also have access to **Bloom**, Edugator's 24/7 AI tutor, which you can use to ask questions and get help while working through problems. The cost of access is **\$8 for one year** for this course.

How to Enroll in Edugator

1. Go to <https://edugator.app/sign-in>
2. Click Continue with UF (GatorLink).
3. Go to the Invitations tab and click Accept for the course invitation.
4. Pay the \$8 access fee. Once payment is complete, you will have access to the course shell for one year.

If you experience any difficulties, contact support@edugator.app

The image shows the Edugator login interface. At the top, it says "Edugator" with a logo. Below that is a "Welcome Back!" message with a subtext "Please enter your credentials to login." There are two input fields: "Email" with the placeholder "you@uf.edu" and "Password" with a masked password "*****". A "Forgot Password?" link is next to the password field. Below the fields is a blue "Login" button. Underneath the login button is a horizontal line with "or" in the center. Below that is a button that says "Continue with UF (GatorLink)" with a GatorLink icon. At the bottom, there is a link "Don't have an account? Sign Up". A red bracket is drawn around the "Continue with UF (GatorLink)" button.

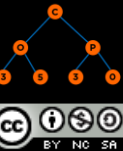
Tools

Directory Structures

- `src` – includes `.h` and `.cpp` files
(You can use `lib/` too for separating interfaces - `.h`)
- `test` – contains test files
- `build` – contains executables (e.g. `.exe`)
- Know basic commands on compilation through command line:
 - `cd`, `ls`, `mv`, `g++`, `pwd` ...

<https://cplusplus.com/forum/beginner/261697>

<https://stackoverflow.com/questions/2360734/whats-a-good-directory-structure-for-larger-c-projects-using-makefile>



Textbook (Optional)

- Data Structures and Algorithm Analysis in C++
 - Mark Allen Weiss
 - Fourth edition, 2014, ISBN 9780132847377
- OpenDSA Book
 - <https://opensa-server.cs.vt.edu/OpenDSA/Books/Everything/html/index.html>

Feedback

- COP 3530 Feedback Form
- Bug Bounty Program
 - Quiz is not accessible due to a locked module
 - Typo in one of the quizzes/project descriptions
 - Incorrect solution in a certain test case
 - An accessibility bug such as no headings in documents for screen-readers
 - the algorithm has an off-by-one error

Expectations

- We want you to focus on
 - Correctness
 - Clean, readable, tested, and documented code
 - Secondary focus on optimization
- The course will not cover
 - Mathematical Proofs
 - Design Patterns
 - Competitive Programming

Expectations

Conceptual Quizzes and Exams:

- Work independently
- No discussion at the conceptual level
- You are allowed to
 - discuss solutions after the due date and late days have passed.

Expectations

Programming Quiz questions:

- Work independently or as a pair (Select a buddy in Week 1).
- The buddy must remain the same for the entire course.
- The course staff can help you on syntax issues, but we will not help you with semantic and logic issues for quizzes.
- Cite that you worked with a buddy in Line 1 of your code and add their name.
- You are allowed to
 - discuss solutions after the due date and late days have passed.
 - search for C++ syntax or refer to definitions of standard functions in the C++ library. For example, using the documentation listed here is fine: <https://www.cplusplus.com/reference/> or <https://en.cppreference.com/w/>

Academic Dishonesty

Project 1 and 3:

- **Work independently**
- Discussion at the conceptual level is fine if you are stuck with no sharing/viewing of code
- **You are allowed to**
 - **discuss conceptually** without discussing any code with a peer provided you cite the peer with who you discussed it. Such discussions should be held **on a whiteboard** using explanation figures/pseudo-codes or through talking.
 - discuss **solutions after the due date and late days** have passed.
 - search for C++ syntax or **refer to definitions of standard functions in the C++ library**. For example, using the documentation listed here is fine: <https://www.cplusplus.com/reference/> or <https://en.cppreference.com/w/>

Academic Dishonesty

Project 2 and Edugator ungraded questions:

- It is fine to **collaborate with peers**. You must make sure you are not blindly copy-pasting another student's code. Also, **you must cite the peer you worked** with at the code level or conceptually.

Academic Dishonesty and GenAI policy

- Sharing, copying, “borrowing” code, viewing another student’s work, or plagiarism of any form is academic dishonesty. You may not view or share external code, search for solutions online, use genAI tools such as ChatGPT to generate entire functions/programs, use AI tools to write/translate reports, or have someone else complete your work.
- AI tools may be used for learning concepts or subtasks, but not to produce solutions for quizzes, exams, or projects. If GenAI tools are used for learning, you must cite the tool, model, and prompt.
- Penalty
 - reported to the Honor Court
 - E grade for the course
- Regret Clause:
 - If you submit an assignment, in which you engaged in some of the unacceptable practices, you may bring it to my attention by emailing me and withdrawing your assignment within 48 hours of the submission. If you do so, I will assign a failing grade of 0 for the assignment, and you will not be reported to the administration.

Request for Extensions

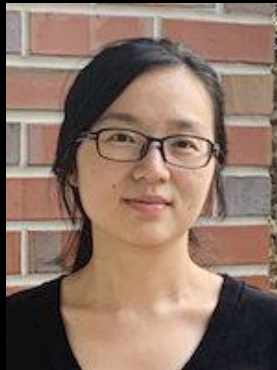
- Any request for assessment extensions should be backed by official documentation (e.g., from a medical professional, etc.) and should be sent over email. Requests without documentation will be ignored. The following reasons deem ineligibility for extensions or regrades:
 - **Failure to submit on Canvas by due date/late date.** Example: If a quiz is due at 11:59 pm, and you send the file at 12:01 am, the file will not be graded. Note that most assessments are open for 4 or more days and you must start early and submit it on time. In case you miss an assignment, treat it as a learning activity and avoid that in the future.
 - **Forgetting to turn in an assessment on time.**
 - **File naming issues or feedback issues on projects.** Gradescope gives you feedback and please read it and fix your file and resubmit. Note that you have unlimited attempts on Gradescope for everything and we will not grade your files if you do not adhere to instructions on file submissions and/or if the Gradescope scores your file to 0. It is your responsibility to read the feedback and fix your code. In case you miss reading the feedback, treat it as a learning activity and avoid that in the future.

Acknowledgements



Cheryl Resch

Lecturer,
Dept. of Engineering Education,
University of Florida



Lisha Zhou

Lecturer,
Dept. of Engineering Education,
University of Florida

References

- Books/Notes

- [Dr. Sartaj Sahni](#)
- [Dr. James Aspen](#)
- Dr. Mark Weiss
- [Dr. Clifford Shaffer](#)
- [OpenDSA](#)
- [Dr. Cathy Hughes](#)

- Videos Authority

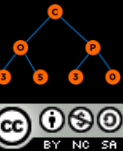
- [Dr. Josh Hug](#)
- [MIT OCW 6.006](#): Dr. Erik Demaine and Dr. Srinivas Devadas
- [Dr. Robert Sedgewick](#)

- Videos Youtube

- [HackerRank: Data Structures](#)
- [HackerRank: Algorithms](#)
- [Back To Back SWE](#)
- [MyCodeSchool](#)
- [Abdul Bari](#)

- GeeksforGeeks

Walkthrough



Walkthrough

- Canvas
- OpenDSA
- Slack
- Edugator
- Gradescope

Questions

